

Word family: **concentrate / concentrates / concentrated / concentrating / concentration / concentrated**

Base word: concentrate

Forms: concentrates, concentrated, concentrating

Related form: concentration

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / adjective through **concentrated** (形容詞化用法)

Your sentence:

> “The constant clatter of trays, background chatter and frequent interruptions are hardly conducive to serious **concentration**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **concentration** means **the mental state or ability of directing your full attention to one thing without being distracted**.

繁體中文： **專注；集中精神；把注意力持續放在某件事情上的能力 / 狀態**

中文翻譯：

> “...are hardly conducive to serious **concentration**.”

「.....很難有助於認真的**專注 / 集中精神**。」

Here:

serious concentration = 長時間把注意力集中在學習上，不受外界干擾

1. **concentrate = focus your attention on something (注意力) — 專心；集中精神**

This is the verb branch directly behind your passage.

Practice 1

> “It is difficult to **concentrate** in a noisy restaurant.”

「在嘈雜的餐廳裡很難**集中精神**。」

Practice 2

> “Please **concentrate on** your work.”

「請**專心做**你的工作。」

Practice 3

> “She was too tired to **concentrate**.”

「她太累，無法**集中精神**。」

concentrate = 把注意力集中在某件事上，排除其他干擾

Common:

* concentrate on something

* concentrate hard

* concentrate fully

* unable to concentrate

2. **concentration = focused mental attention (專注力) — 專注；集中力**

This is the exact passage form.

Practice 4 — Original

> “Noise makes serious **concentration** difficult.”

「噪音令人很難真正**集中精神**。」

Practice 5

> “Good **concentration** is essential during an examination.”

「考試期間良好的**專注力**非常重要。」

Practice 6

> “Her **concentration** was broken by the sudden noise.”

「突如其來的聲音打斷了她的**專注**。」

Common:

* lose concentration

* break someone's concentration

- * improve concentration
- * require concentration
- * powers of concentration

3. **concentrate = focus effort, resources, power, etc. on one aim (努力 / 資源) — 集中 ; 集中
投放**

The object does not have to be mental attention.

Practice 7

> “The company will **concentrate** its resources on its most successful products.”

「公司會把資源**集中投放**在最成功的產品上。」

Practice 8

> “We should **concentrate our efforts on** solving the main problem.”

「我們應該把努力**集中在**解決主要問題上。」

concentrate something on something = 把有限的時間、力量、資源或努力集中用於某一個目標

Common:

- * concentrate efforts
- * concentrate resources
- * concentrate investment
- * concentrate attention
- * concentrate fire

This is a major figurative extension of the attention sense.

4. **concentrate fire = direct attacks/firepower at one target (軍事) — 集中火力**

Practice 9

> “The units **concentrated their fire** on one position.”

「各單位把**火力集中**在一個位置。」

This belongs to Meaning 3 rather than requiring a separate core meaning.

5. **concentrate = bring people/things together in one place (聚集) — 集中 ; 聚集**

A major distinct physical/spatial branch.

Practice 10

> “Most of the shops are **concentrated** in the town centre.”

「大部分商店都**集中**在市中心。」

Practice 11

> “The population is heavily **concentrated** along the coast.”

「人口高度**集中**在沿海地區。」

Practice 12

> “The industry has become **concentrated** in a few large cities.”

「這個行業已逐漸**集中**在幾個大城市。」

concentrate = 令原本分散的人、事物或活動集中到較小的地方 / 範圍

This is genuinely different from mental focus.

6. **concentration = large amount gathered in one area (聚集) — 集中 ; 密集 ; 聚集程度**

Practice 13

> “There is a high **concentration** of restaurants in this district.”

「這個地區的餐廳非常**集中 / 密集**。」

Practice 14

> “The city has a large **concentration** of technology companies.”

「這座城市聚集了大量科技公司。」

a concentration of X = 某種人 / 事物大量聚集在同一地方

Common:

- * concentration of population
- * concentration of wealth
- * concentration of businesses
- * concentration of power

7. **concentration of power/wealth/ownership (社會 / 商業) — 權力 / 財富 / 所有權集中**

The spatial idea extends abstractly.

Practice 15

> “The merger increased the **concentration of ownership** in the industry.”

「這次合併提高了行業中的**所有權集中程度**。」

Practice 16

> “A high **concentration of power** in one office may create governance risks.”

「權力過度**集中**於單一職位可能造成治理風險。」

For strict counting, this belongs to Meaning 6.

8. **concentrate = make a liquid/substance stronger by removing water or another component (物質) — 濃縮**

A major scientific and commercial meaning.

Practice 17

> “The juice is **concentrated** by removing some of the water.”

「果汁透過除去部分水分而被**濃縮**。」

Practice 18

> “The solution was heated to **concentrate** it.”

「溶液被加熱以進行**濃縮**。」

****concentrate a substance = 減少水分 / 溶劑或其他成分，使有效物質所佔比例提高****

9. ****concentrated = containing a high proportion of a substance (濃縮的 / 高濃度的) ****

Practice 19

> “This cleaning fluid is highly ****concentrated****.”

「這種清潔液是高度****濃縮的****。」

Practice 20

> “Do not use the ****concentrated**** solution directly.”

「不要直接使用這種****高濃度****溶液。」

****concentrated = 某種成分的比例很高，通常比正常 / 稀釋狀態更強****

Common:

* concentrated juice

* concentrated solution

* concentrated acid

* concentrated detergent

10. ****concentration = amount of a substance within a mixture (化學 / 科學) — 濃度****

This is one of the most important scientific family meanings.

Practice 21

> “The ****concentration**** of salt in the water increased.”

「水中的鹽****濃度****上升了。」

Practice 22

> “Researchers measured the oxygen ****concentration****.”

「研究人員測量了氧氣****濃度****。」

****concentration = 某種物質在一定體積 / 質量的混合物中所佔的量****

Common:

- * concentration of glucose
- * pollutant concentration
- * drug concentration
- * oxygen concentration

This must be kept separate from:

> concentration = 專注力.

11. ****concentrate = noun: concentrated product/substance (濃縮物) — 濃縮物 ; 濃縮液****

As a noun, ****concentrate**** means a substance from which some material—often water—has been removed, producing a stronger product.

Practice 23

> “The juice is made from orange ****concentrate****.”

「這種果汁是用橙汁****濃縮液****製成的。」

Practice 24

> “Mix one part ****concentrate**** with four parts water.”

「把一份****濃縮液****和四份水混合。」

Common:

- * juice concentrate
- * fruit concentrate
- * tomato concentrate

This is a genuinely distinct noun sense.

12. ****concentrate = mineral-rich material after processing (採礦 / 冶金) — 精礦 ; 濃縮礦物****

In mineral processing, a ****concentrate**** is material enriched in the desired mineral after unwanted material has been removed.

Practice 25

> “The plant produces copper **concentrate**.”

「這間工廠生產銅**精礦**。」

Database status: genuine specialist extension of the concentrated-substance noun.

13. **concentrate** = nutrient-dense animal feed (農業) — 精飼料；濃縮飼料

In animal nutrition, **concentrate** can refer to feed rich in nutrients and relatively low in fibre compared with roughage.

Practice 26

> “The cattle are given grain **concentrate**.”

「牛隻獲餵食穀物**精飼料**。」

This is a genuine agricultural noun but lower priority.

14. **concentrated** = intense and focused (努力 / 活動) — 集中的；密集的

Practice 27

> “The project required a period of **concentrated** effort.”

「這個項目需要一段時間的**集中努力**。」

Practice 28

> “The area experienced **concentrated** development.”

「該區出現**高度集中 / 密集的**發展。」

This adjective comes from either:

- * focused effort, or
- * spatial concentration.

Context determines the meaning.

15. **concentrated = highly intense or powerful (效果) — 強烈的 ; 高度集中的**

Practice 29

> “The campaign involved a **concentrated** burst of advertising.”

「這項活動包含一段**高度密集的**廣告宣傳。」

For strict counting, this belongs to the focused/intensified branch rather than creating another core sense.

Important fixed/historical compound: **concentration camp**

A **concentration camp** is a place where large numbers of people are detained and concentrated under government or military authority, typically without ordinary criminal trial procedures and often under harsh conditions.

繁體中文 : ** **集中營

This is a historically and politically important fixed compound.

Its meaning comes historically from:

> **concentration = bringing/detaining people together in one place**

but today the compound has a very specific historical/institutional meaning and should be learned as a fixed term, not interpreted mechanically as just “a camp with many people.”

Related form: **concentratedly**

Modern standard English does **not** normally use *concentratedly* as a practical everyday adverb.

Prefer:

> with concentration

> intently

> with focused attention

So this family is rich semantically but not morphologically large.

Important distinction: **concentrate vs focus**

focus

is the broader everyday verb.

concentrate

often suggests sustained, deliberate mental effort.

> “Focus on the screen.”

> “I need quiet so I can concentrate.”

For attention, they overlap heavily.

Important distinction: **concentrate vs pay attention**

pay attention

= direct your attention to something.

concentrate

= maintain that attention strongly, often for a period of time.

A student can pay attention briefly but still struggle to concentrate for an hour.

Important distinction: **concentrate vs think**

think

is general mental activity.

concentrate

means deliberately narrow your attention to the task.

> “I’m thinking about the question.”

> “I need silence to concentrate.”

Different emphasis.

Important distinction: **concentration vs attention**

attention

= mental noticing/focus directed toward something.

concentration

= sustained, intensive attention.

So:

> “Pay attention!”

often refers to the immediate moment.

> “This task requires concentration.”

emphasizes sustained mental effort.

Important distinction: **concentration vs focus**

As nouns, they overlap.

focus

can mean the specific centre of attention:

> “The focus of the lesson is grammar.”

concentration

more often describes the mental ability/state:

> “Noise destroys my concentration.”

You normally would not say:

> “Noise destroys the focus of the lesson”

if you mean a student’s mental attention.

Important distinction: **concentrated vs strong — liquids**

strong

is broad and may refer to:

- * taste
- * smell
- * effect
- * chemical strength

concentrated

specifically suggests:

> a high proportion of the active/substantive component, often because liquid/solvent has been removed.

> concentrated juice

> strong coffee

Not always interchangeable.

Important distinction: **concentrate vs condense**

concentrate a solution

= increase the proportion of dissolved material, often by removing solvent.

condense

in physics:

= change gas/vapour into liquid.

In writing:

= make something shorter.

So these verbs should not be confused.

Important distinction: **concentrate vs gather**

gather

means come together / collect.

concentrate

emphasizes becoming **densely or disproportionately located in one place**.

> “People gathered outside.”

> “Wealth is concentrated in a small number of households.”

The second emphasizes distribution.

Important distinction: **concentrate vs centralize**

centralize

means deliberately organize control/functions in one central authority/place.

concentrate

simply means bring a large proportion together.

> centralize administration

> concentrate resources

There is overlap but not identity.

Grammar note: **concentrate on**

For mental attention:

- > concentrate on your homework
- > concentrate on what she is saying

For strategic effort:

- > concentrate on the main problem

This is the most important construction.

Grammar note: **concentrate something on something**

Transitive:

- > concentrate resources on education
- > concentrate fire on one target

= 把某種資源 / 力量集中在.....

Grammar note: **be concentrated in / around**

For location:

- > “Population is concentrated in urban areas.”
- > “Most restaurants are concentrated around the station.”

= 集中於 / 聚集在.....

Grammar note: **concentration of**

Two very different interpretations are possible.

Spatial/abstract gathering

- > concentration of wealth

= 財富集中

Scientific amount

> concentration of salt

= 鹽濃度

The following noun and context determine the sense.

Countability note

Mental concentration

Usually uncountable:

> need concentration

> lose concentration

Scientific concentration

Can be countable when referring to measured levels:

> different concentrations of the chemical

Spatial concentration

Countable:

> a large concentration of shops

Noun **concentrate**

Often countable or mass depending on the product:

> orange concentrate

> several mineral concentrates

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **concentrate**

* **concentrates**

* **concentrated**

* **concentrating**

* **concentration**

Useful constructions and domain forms include:

- * concentrate on
- * concentrate attention
- * concentrate efforts
- * concentrate resources
- * concentrated population
- * concentrated solution
- * concentration of a chemical
- * concentration of wealth/power
- * juice concentrate
- * mineral concentrate
- * concentration camp

A full second-pass audit shows that the semantic network divides into three strong conceptual clusters:

1. **direct mental/strategic focus toward one point**
2. **bring people/things together into a smaller space or distribution**
3. **increase the proportion/strength of a substance**

The noun **concentration** then develops major meanings from all three.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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concentrate — mental attention	把注意力集中在某件事上；專心
concentration — mental	持續集中精神、不受干擾的專注狀態 / 能力
concentrate — effort/resources	把力量、時間、資源等集中用在某一目標
concentrate — spatial	把原本分散的人、事物或活動集中到較小範圍
concentration — spatial	某類人 / 事物大量聚集或高度集中
concentration of power/wealth	權力、財富、所有權等集中於較少的人 / 單位
concentrate — substance	除去水分 / 溶劑等，使某物質的有效成分比例提高；濃縮
concentrated — substance	高濃度的；經濃縮的
concentration — chemistry/science	某種物質在混合物中的含量 / 濃度
concentrate — noun	濃縮液 / 濃縮物
mineral concentrate	加工後富含目標礦物的精礦
feed concentrate	高營養、低粗纖維的精飼料；農業專門
concentration camp	集中營；固定歷史 / 制度性詞語

For your original sentence

> “The constant clatter of trays, background chatter and frequent interruptions are hardly conducive to serious **concentration**.”

The exact meaning is:

concentration = 學生長時間把注意力完整地放在學習、閱讀或完成練習上，而不被外界聲音和活動打斷的能力 / 狀態

So:

> **serious concentration**

= **高度專注 / 認真集中精神**

The sentence is **not** using the scientific sense:

> concentration = 濃度

nor the distribution sense:

> concentration of people/businesses = 集中程度.

For your database, I would count **5 genuinely useful core meanings** across **concentrate**:

1. **focus mental attention**
2. **focus efforts, resources, power, etc. on one goal**
3. **bring people/things together in one place or narrow area**
4. **make a substance stronger by increasing its proportion / removing solvent**
5. **noun `concentrate`: concentrated substance or product**

For the family, **concentration** deserves especially prominent treatment because it independently means:

- * **專注 / 集中精神**
- * **聚集 / 集中程度**
- * **化學 / 科學濃度**

Those three are common and genuinely distinct.